

Valtrus Innovations Ltd. v. TRG Datacenters,

Public complaint analysis reports assertion of U.S. Patent No. 6,868,682 against TRG data-center cooling systems, including equipment associated with Vertiv/Liebert, Stulz, Trane, Schneider Electric, and DataAire. The patent describes agent-based control in which agents receive sensory temperature data, adjust cooling-fluid delivery, and request or coordinate additional resources when local control is insufficient.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-18	S.D. Tex.	4:26-cv-06818	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-25. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	Valtrus Innovations Ltd. et al. v. TRG Datacenters, LLC
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FORUM / DOCKET	S.D. Tex. / 4:26-cv-06818
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FILED / TYPE	2026-08-18 / patent infringement
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PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket
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VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public federal docket identifies Valtrus Innovations Ltd. and Key Patent Innovations Ltd. as plaintiffs and TRG Datacenters, LLC as defendant, verifies filing on August 18, 2026 in the Southern District of Texas under docket 4:26-cv-06818, characterizes the matter as patent infringement, and identifies Eric H. Findlay as the attorney filing the complaint.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Eric H. Findlay - Outside counsel and complaint filer for Valtrus and Key Patent Innovations; attorney at Findlay Craft, P.C.. The exact public docket identifies Findlay as the complaint filer for plaintiffs. A public USPTO PTAB filing prints his direct professional email. Selecting him as the likely research purchaser is an inference from that verified role.

efindlay@findlaycraft.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

Public complaint analysis reports assertion of U.S. Patent No. 6,868,682 against TRG data-center cooling systems, including equipment associated with Vertiv/Liebert, Stulz, Trane, Schneider Electric, and DataAire. The patent describes agent-based control in which agents receive sensory temperature data, adjust cooling-fluid delivery, and request or coordinate additional resources when local control is insufficient.

Secondary-source limitation: The public docket and secondary analysis verify the new matter and reported patent, but the complaint PDF, asserted claims, accused-site configurations, control software, equipment versions, and operating records were not reviewed. Those primary materials and discovery must control any infringement, damages, or validity opinion. The patent is expired, so the temporal scope and any claimed past damages require separate legal analysis. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 6,868,682](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 What accused system corresponds to each claimed agent and resource?

The analysis should identify any first and second agents, their controlled cooling resources, sensory inputs, command outputs, hierarchy, communications, and the physical equipment performing fluid-delivery changes.

Potential evidence: Complaint and claim charts; BMS/DCIM source code and configuration; control diagrams; equipment manuals; network topology; API and point lists; site inspection

02 How are temperature measurements acquired, associated, and used?

Sensor identity, placement, sampling, calibration, filtering, thresholds, zones, and association with equipment or compute load may determine whether the claimed sensory-data relationships exist.

Potential evidence: Sensor maps; calibration records; time-series historian data; control code; alarm definitions; commissioning and maintenance records

03 Does a first agent adjust delivery of cooling fluid?

A technical mapping should distinguish recommendations, setpoint changes, actuator commands, fan or pump control, valve movement, chilled-water flow, air delivery, and manual operator action.

Potential evidence: Source code; controller logic; command logs; actuator and valve records; fan/pump curves; sequence-of-operations documents; live or replay testing

04 What happens when local cooling is insufficient?

The reported claims concern a first agent requesting or coordinating help from a second agent. The system should be tested for escalation triggers, message content, resource selection, override behavior, failure modes, and human intervention.

Potential evidence: Agent messages; APIs; alarms; workflow and escalation rules; event logs; test scripts; operator procedures; incident records

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Is the control distributed and agent-based or merely conventional supervisory control?

Terminology alone is insufficient. Experts should analyze autonomy, state, goals, communication, hierarchy, decision authority, and resource allocation to distinguish claimed agents from ordinary thermostats, PLC loops, or centralized BMS logic.

Potential evidence: Architecture documents; software modules; controller state machines; source code; standards and contemporaneous agent-system literature

06 Which equipment, sites, software versions, and operating periods are implicated?

TRG may deploy different Vertiv/Liebert, Stulz, Trane, Schneider, DataAire, BMS, DCIM, firmware, and custom-control combinations. Version and site matrices are essential, especially for an expired patent and any past-damages theory.

Potential evidence: Site and equipment inventories; firmware/software versions; commissioning dates; change logs; purchase and service records; archived configurations

07 How should performance and causation be tested?

Controlled replay or simulation should determine whether agent actions alter temperature or cooling-fluid delivery, whether other controls dominate, and how delay, hysteresis, sensor error, and capacity constraints affect conclusions.

Potential evidence: Historian data; digital-twin or calibrated model; controlled tests; heat-load data; CFD and thermal models; uncertainty and sensitivity analysis

08 What prior art disclosed hierarchical or cooperative thermal-control agents?

Validity research should cover data centers, telecom facilities, building automation, HVAC supervisory control, multi-agent systems, distributed resource allocation, and electronics cooling before the patent priority date.

Potential evidence: Patents; conference and journal papers; standards; vendor manuals; theses; source-code archives; dated installations; element-by-element prior-art charts

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Bahgat G. Sammakia

SUNY Distinguished Professor and Director, Center for Energy-Smart Electronic Systems, Binghamton University

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for data-center thermal management, energy-efficient electronic systems, cooling architecture, modeling, controls, and industry-scale implementation. His work directly bridges sensor data, cooling-fluid delivery, facility operation, and coordinated optimization.

RELEVANT WORK

Binghamton identifies him as ES2 center director with research in thermal management and energy optimization; his profile reports more than 350 publications and 40 patents. He coauthored a book on data-center energy efficiency and thermal management.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Bahgat G. Sammakia was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Extensive ES2 industry relationships and prior projects require careful conflict diligence. Public sources do not establish work on the accused TRG facilities or the asserted patent.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | bahgat@binghamton.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Dereje Agonafer

Presidential Distinguished Professor, University of Texas at Arlington; former Director, Electronics, MEMS and Nanoelectronics Systems Packaging Center

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for data-center cooling, thermal management, airflow and liquid-cooling systems, electronics packaging, and energy efficiency. He can address how sensors, cooling equipment, and facility-level control interact.

RELEVANT WORK

UTA identifies him as an NAE member whose research includes data-center cooling and thermal management; public university materials describe DOE-supported work on more efficient data-center cooling.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Dereje Agonafer was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Public sources do not establish direct experience with the asserted patent, TRG, or the specific Vertiv, Stulz, Trane, Schneider, or DataAire deployments. Current role and capacity require confirmation.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | agonafer@uta.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Yogendra K. Joshi

John M. McKenney and Warren D. Shiver Distinguished Chair and Professor, George W. Woodruff School of Mechanical Engineering, Georgia Tech

TECHNICAL FIT

Exceptional fit for thermal management of electronics and data centers, heat transfer, liquid cooling, airflow, and energy-efficient facilities. Relevant to both claimed sensory-control relationships and physical cooling performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Georgia Tech identifies his research in thermal management and data centers. He coauthored Data Center Energy Efficiency, Thermal Management, and Data Center Technology and holds extensive publications and professional leadership in thermal science.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Yogendra K. Joshi was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Strong thermal-systems expertise but public sources do not establish agent-based software or claim-construction work. Industry and academic relationships require conflict review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | yogendra.joshi@me.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Alfonso Ortega

Professor of Mechanical Engineering, Villanova University; site leader in the Center for Energy-Smart Electronic Systems

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for thermal management, electronics cooling, data-center efficiency, experimental heat transfer, and system-level analysis. Relevant to cooling-fluid delivery, limits of local cooling resources, and escalation to facility-level control.

RELEVANT WORK

ES2 publicly identifies him as Villanova site director. His academic work covers thermal management and electronics cooling, including air and liquid heat-transfer systems.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Alfonso Ortega was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public email source identifies a 2022 ES2 leadership role, so current appointment and contact should be reconfirmed. No public source reviewed ties him to the parties or patent.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | alfonso.ortega@villanova.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Justin A. Weibel

Professor of Mechanical Engineering and Director, Cooling Technologies Research Center, Purdue University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for advanced electronics cooling, phase-change heat transfer, heat pipes, cold plates, thermal-system analysis, and data-center efficiency. Relevant to cooling-fluid delivery mechanisms and whether measured conditions trigger or justify additional cooling resources.

RELEVANT WORK

Purdue identifies him as CTRC director and a researcher in advanced electronics cooling, phase-change transport, thermal management, and energy efficiency. Purdue reports ARPA-E COOLERCHIPS work with Intel on two-phase immersion cooling for data centers.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Justin A. Weibel was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His strongest work concerns component and rack-scale heat removal rather than distributed software agents or patent history. Industry-sponsored center relationships require conflict review.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | jaweibel@purdue.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Nenad Miljkovic

Founder Professor and Director, Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Center, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for heat transfer, fluid mechanics, refrigeration, two-phase cooling, heat exchangers, cold plates, and electronics cooling. Relevant to cooling-capacity limits, fluid-delivery performance, sensor-response relationships, and alternative cooling architectures.

RELEVANT WORK

Illinois lists current work on ultra-low-resistance cold plates for liquid cooling of electronics and broad heat-transfer enhancement. His profile publicly lists active expert-witness engagements, establishing litigation experience without implying availability here.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

The official Illinois faculty profile lists expert-witness engagements with Quinn Emanuel, Eckert Seamans, and Paul Hastings during 2024-2026. The public profile does not identify subject matter, opinions, outcomes, or any relationship to this matter.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

Active consulting and expert engagements increase conflicts diligence. His deepest expertise is thermo-fluid hardware, not software-agent hierarchy or historical patent interpretation.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | nmiljkov@illinois.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 Srinivas Garimella

Hightower Chair in Engineering and Professor, George W. Woodruff School of Mechanical Engineering, Georgia Tech

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for thermal systems, heat exchangers, absorption and phase-change systems, minichannel heat transfer, and energy conversion. Relevant to cooling-fluid delivery, heat rejection, capacity, and facility thermal performance.

RELEVANT WORK

Georgia Tech reports more than 250 publications and books addressing minichannel heat transfer, condensation, and thermal systems. His laboratory develops compact heat and mass transfer technologies.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Srinivas Garimella was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public work is hardware and thermal-science centered rather than data-center control software. No current-matter or asserted-patent relationship was established.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | srinivas.garimella@me.gatech.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Ganesh Subbarayan

James G. Dwyer Professor of Mechanical Engineering, Purdue University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for heat and mass transfer, computational engineering, electronics packaging, reliability, and coupled thermal-mechanical modeling. Relevant to sensor placement, temperature-field reconstruction, equipment response, and reliability under cooling excursions.

RELEVANT WORK

Purdue identifies his work in computational engineering, heat and mass transfer, micro/nanotechnology, electronics packaging, reliability, and advanced materials.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Ganesh Subbarayan was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

More focused on electronics packaging and computational mechanics than whole-facility cooling control or agent-based software. Sponsored-research relationships require conflict review.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | ganeshs@purdue.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Satish G. Kandlikar

Gleason Professor of Mechanical Engineering, Rochester Institute of Technology

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for convective heat transfer, flow boiling, minichannels, heat exchangers, and liquid-cooling performance. Relevant to cooling-fluid flow, heat-removal limits, transitions between operating regimes, and experimental validation.

RELEVANT WORK

RIT identifies his research in flow boiling, heat transfer enhancement, microchannels, and thermal systems, with extensive publications and professional recognition in heat transfer.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Satish G. Kandlikar was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His work is fundamental and experimental heat transfer rather than data-center supervisory controls or patent claim construction. No public link to accused systems was identified.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | sgkeme@rit.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Kanad Ghose

Distinguished Professor and Center Director, School of Computing and Integrated Electronics Engineering Center, Binghamton University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong complementary fit for power-aware computer architecture, energy-smart systems, high-performance computing, communication systems, and coordinated control. Relevant to the asserted hierarchy of software agents and how compute workload, sensors, and cooling controls exchange state.

RELEVANT WORK

Binghamton identifies him as a Distinguished Professor researching computer architecture, power-aware systems, and high-performance computing and communication. ES2 materials identify him as a center site director.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No candidate-specific public expert report, declaration, deposition, or trial-testimony record for Kanad Ghose was located in the bounded public-source review. This is not proof that the candidate has never served in litigation; PACER, paid expert databases, retention records, and conflict systems were not searched.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

He is a computing and energy-aware systems expert rather than a thermo-fluid specialist; physical cooling-performance opinions would need a companion thermal expert. ES2 relationships require conflict diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | ghose@cs.binghamton.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://dockets.justia.com/docket/texas/txsdce/4%3A2026cv06818/2104097>

Public professional email source: <https://ptacts.uspto.gov/ptacts/public-informations/petitions/1558063/download-documents?artifactId=osNkaKTLMAmRR90Qw8aERyymrwJelXtmizpkJhk95pNWohdqBfaclhM>

Public technical context source: <https://ai-lab.exparte.com/case/dct/txsd/4%3A26-cv-06818/doc/analysis/1>

LIMITATIONS

The public docket and secondary analysis verify the new matter and reported patent, but the complaint PDF, asserted claims, accused-site configurations, control software, equipment versions, and operating records were not reviewed. Those primary materials and discovery must control any infringement, damages, or validity opinion. The patent is expired, so the temporal scope and any claimed past damages require separate legal analysis.

No attorney or expert was contacted. No availability, interest, mailbox delivery, or conflict clearance is claimed.